

**Deepika****Padukone, 23**

The newbie has done movies with major stars and scored hits, from *Om Shanti Om* to *Love Aaj Kal*.

are never too far away from half hour specials on tv and tabloid headlines. Both have become fashion icons, Kareena for her size zero figure and Priyanka for her draped minis. Both have had mixed luck at the box office but haven't shied away from taking risks. So if Kareena, who began in 2000 with J.P. Dutta's *Refugee*, did a tiny film like *Jab We Met* for Imtiaz Ali, she also did a big budget splash—and ultimately bomb—like *Tashan*. And Priyanka, who made her debut in 2002 with a Tamil film, has done a demanding *Fashion* with Madhur Bhandarkar but also a sci-fi turkey like *Drona*. The months ahead typify their adventurous nature. Kareena will be seen in what Rensil D'Silva calls an "author-backed" role in *Kurbaan* as Avantika, a college lecturer in Delhi who returns to teach in New York, as well as in Rajkumar Hirani's *3 Idiots*, where she plays a medical student in love with free spirit Aamir Khan. Priyanka plays the beauty whom a geek is in love with in *Pyaar Impossible* and Ranbir Kapoor's love interest in Siddharth Anand's *Anjaana Anjaani*. Proof of moviemakers' confidence in her ability to open movies? Her co-star in *Fashion* was Arjun Bajwa, in *What's Your Raashee?* it was Harman Baweja and in *Pyaar Impossible* it's Uday Chopra. Both Kareena and Priyanka have learnt to depend on a close-knit army of a publicist, manager, and scheduler, who ensure they divide their time between their many commitments. Their professionalism has impressed the best in the business. Ask Hirani about Kareena and he can only say how she would invariably remind him about a costume fitting or a reading. And be on time. Ask Vishal Bharadwaj about Priyanka (who worked with him on *Kaminey*) and he will say how impressed he was with her commitment to learn Marathi, travelling everywhere with her tutor for four months. So whether it is putting on weight for *3 Idiots* for Kareena or losing it for *Tashan*; whether it is developing a unibrow for *What's Your Raashee?* or learning martial arts for *Don* for Priyanka, the diva duo will stop at nothing.

Katrina Kaif, 25

A newcomer to India, despite being dubbed in most movies, she has become an enormously successful trophy heroine.

The IT Girls

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